Contact

k.weber@example.de
www.linkedin.com/in/katharinaweber (LinkedIn)
kweber.example.de (Personal)
spreewald-mobility.example.com (Company)

Top Skills

Engineering Leadership
Platform Architecture
Organizational Design

Languages

German (Native or Bilingual)
English (Full Professional)
Spanish (Elementary)

Certifications

Certified Scrum Professional
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional
ITIL 4 Foundation
Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

Honors-Awards

Top 50 Women in Tech Germany 2023
Spreewald Mobility Leadership Award

Publications

Scaling Platform Teams Without Losing Speed
Event-Driven Logistics at City Scale

Katharina Weber

VP Engineering | Scaling mobility & logistics platforms from 20 to 200 engineers | Board advisor

Berlin, Berlin, Germany

Summary

I lead engineering organisations through the awkward middle: past product-market fit, before the processes catch up. Over 18 years I have grown teams from 20 to 200 engineers, moved monoliths to platforms without stopping the business, and built leadership benches that outlast me.

At Spreewald Mobility I run a 180-person engineering organisation across Berlin, Lisbon and remote, responsible for the routing, fleet and payments platforms behind 4 million rides a month. We cut infrastructure cost per ride by 38% in two years while doubling deployment frequency.

Before that I spent eight years in logistics software, from senior engineer to Director of Engineering, and two years consulting for public-transport authorities.

I advise two early-stage startups on engineering strategy and speak about platform teams and organisational design. I'm happy to talk about engineering leadership, hiring in Europe, and mentoring new managers.

Experience

Spreewald Mobility GmbH

6 years 7 months

VP Engineering

June 2022 - Present (4 years 5 months)
Berlin, Germany

Lead a 180-person engineering organisation (14 teams, 3 locations) and own the technical strategy for routing, fleet and payments.

• Cut infrastructure cost per ride by 38% through a platform consolidation programme.

• Doubled deployment frequency to 60 releases a day with a paved-road CI/CD platform.

• Built a management bench of 18 engineering managers, 11 of them promoted internally.

• Introduced a career framework adopted company-wide; regretted attrition fell from 14% to 6%.

Director of Engineering

April 2020 - May 2022 (2 years 2 months)
Berlin, Germany

Led the routing and dispatch groups (60 engineers) through 3x ride growth.

• Replaced the dispatch monolith with event-driven services on Kafka, cutting dispatch latency from 9 s to 1.2 s.

• Set up the SRE function and an incident review practice; availability rose from 99.5% to 99.95%.

Havelland Logistics AG

8 years 2 months

Head of Engineering

September 2016 - March 2020 (3 years 7 months)
Potsdam, Germany

Ran engineering for the warehouse management suite used by 300 sites across the DACH region.

• Grew the team from 25 to 70 engineers and opened a second office in Leipzig.

• Led the move to a multi-tenant SaaS product, which became 60% of revenue within two years.

Engineering Manager

January 2014 - August 2016 (2 years 8 months)
Potsdam, Germany

Managed two teams building the route-optimisation engine; cut average delivery mileage by 12% for the largest customer.

Senior Software Engineer

February 2012 - December 2013 (1 year 11 months)
Potsdam, Germany

Built the real-time vehicle tracking service in Java and PostgreSQL.

Verkehrsplan Beratung

Software Consultant

January 2010 - January 2012 (2 years 1 month)
Hamburg, Germany

Delivered timetable-planning tools for three regional public-transport authorities.

• Led a team of five on a passenger-information system that went live across 1,200 stops.

Fraunhofer Institute for Transportation and Infrastructure Systems

Research Engineer

October 2007 - December 2009 (2 years 3 months)
Dresden, Germany

Researched traffic-flow simulation; co-authored four peer-reviewed papers on adaptive signal control.

Startup Advisory

Board Advisor

2021 - Present (5 years 10 months)

Advise two seed-stage mobility startups on engineering strategy, hiring and technical due diligence.

Education

Technische Universität Dresden

Diplom-Informatikerin, Computer Science · (2001 - 2007)

Universidad Politécnica de Madrid

Erasmus exchange, Computer Science · (2005 - 2006)